

James K. Howard

CONTACT

📍 Toronto, ON

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Portfolio Website:

<https://www.jameskhoward.com>

EDUCATION

Honours BA: 2020

University of Toronto, Toronto,
ON *Double Major – Political
Science and Sociology*

DevOps Program: 2026

University of Toronto Continuing
Studies, Toronto, ON

- *Principles & Practices*
- *Ecosystem, Architecture & Continuous Software Delivery*
- *Tools & Applications*
- *Design & Architecture of Cloud Systems*

Operations & Supply Chain Management: In-Progress

University of Toronto Continuing
Studies, Toronto, ON

- *Principles of Operations & SCM*

CERTS & LICENSES

Stanford Online – Machine Learning Specialization - 2026

*Supervised & unsupervised machine
learning algorithms.*

WORK

Senior Manager – Strategic Initiatives - Supply Chain Technology (Oct 2025 – Present)
Manager – Strategic Initiatives - Supply Chain Technology (Aug 2024 – Sept 2025) // Loblaw
Companies Ltd, Brampton
*Rollout and continuous support for the deployment of Manhattan Active. MA is the Cloud Native
application offered by Manhattan Associates as a Warehousing, Yard and labour solution.*

- **Scope:** Techno-functional lead, project manager & lead, people leader & manager, solutions architect, process improvement lead
- Collaborating with Manhattan's product teams, providing directional input for feature development for future releases.
 - Part of Manhattan's product council, driving prioritization and client needs as part of their portfolio via product road mapping.
- End-to-end product enhancements: inclusive of program critical projects, groomed feature lists, alongside smaller product development. Drove a 250% YoY increase in successfully delivered enhancements, while greatly reducing reliance on consultants, instead promoting internal talent.
 - Synthesized benefits in an executive reporting summary view, helping to communicate value while also keeping our sites apprised of continuous improvement efforts
- New Features: Gap analysis, business alignment, adoption and subsequent rollout of new features across the MAWM Distribution Centers.
- Change and Release Management, handling all production promotion across the distribution network. Created and deployed over 100+ releases, E-2-E.
 - Drove new initiatives around release management, helping to reduce deployment errors by over 300% YoY, while also ensuring stakeholders were apprised and fully aware of all items being moved into production
- Strategic projects:
 - Led the successful introduction and adoption of a new Yard Management Software – Manhattan Active Yard Management, from design, to technical implementation, to continued improvement (Multiple Phases)
 - Preparation and implementation of multiple critical site Go-Lives, re-orienting the code landscape and syncing all environments while adopting DevOps best practices, alongside many other initiatives

Manager – Site Stability - Supply Chain Technology (June 2023 – July 2024) // Loblaw Companies Ltd, Brampton

- **Scope:** Techno-functional manager, project manager, process improvement
- Led the triage of Major Incidents (production issues with significant business impact), ensuring quick remediation.
- Managed our vendor relationship, responsible for directing a team of consultants, both onshore and offshore, while driving their prioritization to achieve production objectives.
- Inherited a production burndown list of over 80 concurrent issues alongside numerous legacy problems, managing to reduce the current standing list by close to 60% to a working list of roughly 30.
- Collaborated with our Business partners and key stakeholders to manage operational support for multiple Distribution Centers across Canada.

Deeplearning.AI – Agentic AI - 2026

Build agentic design patterns, integrate with external tools. Evaluate and optimize AI systems.

Deeplearning.AI – Generative AI for Software Development - 2025

Embedding AI in software and systems design, in tandem with engineering.

AWS – DevOps on AWS - 2024

Implementing DevOps practices in the cloud, exploring strategies for serverless applications alongside adoption of CI/CD.

AWS – Cloud Technology Consultant - 2024

Taking business goals and drivers, translating them into technical solutions. Creating the logical design for cloud solutions, providing technical direction and oversight.

IBM - DevOps and Software Engineering - 2024

Develop a DevOps mindset. Build microservice applications and deploy using cloud strategies, while employing a variety of CI/CD tools for automation (Chef, Puppet, Tekton, Travis, Github Actions).



Web Age Solutions – Full Stack Developer Bootcamp – 2023

Ten peer cohort selected; designed to re-skill Loblaw employees into Web developers. Offered the opportunity to continue as a developer.

Meta – Back-End Developer – 2023

Technical back end skill refinement, focused on REST.

Google - IT Automation with Python - 2022

Automation via scripting and configuration management.

- Handled all incoming Incidents and resulting root cause analysis while meeting business SLAs
- Managed, led and solutioned all resulting issues spawning from previous incidents, delivering quality fixes that satisfied business requirements.
- Owned the production promotion and Change Management process, functioning as the team's release manager.
- As a project manager, led multiple projects to completion leveraging Agile best practices.

IT Specialist - PMO (Jan 2022 – May 2023) // Loblaw Companies Ltd, Brampton

Intern - PMO (May 2021- Dec 2021) // Loblaw Companies Ltd, Brampton

- **Scope:** Technical analyst & PMO specialist
- Internship contract was previously set for 12 months, converted to a FTE after the completion of 8.
- Functioned in various capacities, including process automation (often programmatically), data analysis, IT administration, product management, portfolio reporting, end-user support and end-user training.
- Successfully led all resource management, collaborated with adjacent systems to ensure accurate and punctual payment processing for all Loblaw IT contract work.
- Well versed in the Agile methodology and best practices, having collaborated with Loblaw's Agile Center of Excellence while assisting them in a number of their initiatives.
- Lauded for outstanding tool training; to further this aim, spearheaded the creation of a weekly drop-in session to promote tool best-practices and successful adoption.
- Automated E-2-E our Executive Reporting Packages, incorporating Power Apps, Python and Power BI.

SOFTWARE PROJECTS

Below are a few highlights that I have worked on and subsequently completed in the last 12 months. Click the title to see the project in action. These projects highlight my familiarity with the SDLC and full-stack development.

Portfolio Website

Stack: Next.js, JavaScript, React, TailwindCSS.

Blog

Stack: JavaScript, Next.js, React, TailwindCSS.

Property Rental

Stack: TypeScript, Next.js, React, TailwindCSS, MongoDB.

Communities

Stack: TypeScript, Next.js, React, TailwindCSS, PlanetScale.

SKILLS

Programming Languages: Javascript (TypeScript, Node), Java, Python, SQL, Bash

Key Frameworks and Libraries: React, React-Native, Django, Next.js, Spring Boot, Pandas, Numpy, Express, TailwindCSS

Tools and Platforms: Postman, Git/Gitbash, Android Studio, Expo, Firebase, Maven, Gradle, Power BI, Clarity, Jira, Confluence, MS 365, Docker, Kubernetes, AWS, GCP, Github

Soft skills: Strong communicator, excellent problem-solver, well organized, conscientious team player